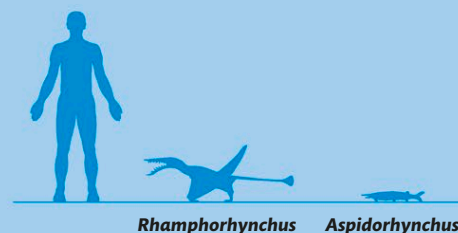


AT A GLANCE

- **YEAR OF DISCOVERY** 2009
- **PLACE** Bavaria, Germany
- **STUDIED BY** Eberhard Frey and Helmut Tischlinger
- **LIVED** 146–145 MYA



Aspidorhynchus's body was covered in tough scales.

A short tail helped propel the fish's streamlined body through the water.

DEADLY ENCOUNTER

ASPIDORHYNCHUS AND RHAMPHORHYNCHUS

This encounter between the fish *Aspidorhynchus* and the pterosaur *Rhamphorhynchus* was very much a case of wrong place, wrong time. Found inside limestone rock in southern Germany, this incredible fossil perfectly captures a snapshot of Jurassic life. *Aspidorhynchus's* large, pointed "bill" accidentally became entangled in the wing membrane of the pterosaur and despite repeated attempts to escape, the fish was unable to free itself. Both creatures sank to the bottom of a lagoon, where the oxygen-poor water suffocated and killed them.